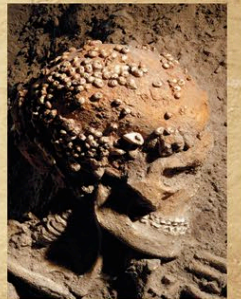


THE OLDEST KNOWN CLAY POTS WERE MADE IN CHINA ABOUT 20,000 YEARS AGO

Earliest burials

Our ancestors began burying their dead with significant objects, such as beads or other decorations, at least 100,000 years ago.

◆ Early burial site



Skull with shells, 25,000 years ago, Balzi Rossi, Italy

Earliest paintings

Humans have painted and carved rock surfaces since at least 40,000 years ago. Some paintings show people dancing and singing.

◆ Early painting site



Inanke Cave, Zimbabwe, 5,000–10,000 years ago

The first sculpture

The earliest known sculpture consists of figurines carved from stone and bone to look like humans and animals. Some date back up to 40,000 years.

◆ Site of artwork

"Lion Man," Germany, 40,000 years ago



Flutes, Hohle Fels Cave, and Geissenklösterle, Germany

Bisovava, Russia

"Lion Man" bone carving, Germany

Sungir Graves, Russia

Carved ivory running lion, Czech Republic

Tata Plaque (mysterious object made by a Neanderthal 100,000 years ago), Hungary

Krapina, Croatia

Balzi Rossi caves, Italy

Tbilisi, Georgia

Pechka rock shelter, Armenia

Shanidar Cave, Iraq

Kashafrud, Iran

Riwat, Pakistan

Majuangou, China

Carved bone disk, Xiaogushan, China

Bone flutes, Jiahu, China

Bhimbetka paintings, India

Bose, China

Isampur, India

Qafzeh, Israel

Shell beads, Skhul, Israel

Chauvet Cave, France

Gebelein, Egypt

Gona, Ethiopia (world's oldest tools)

Konso-Gardula, Ethiopia

Turkana, Kenya

Lokalalei, Kenya

Olduvai Gorge, Tanzania

Island of Socotra, Yemen

Twin Rivers, Zambia

Inanke Cave, Zimbabwe

Sterkfontein, South Africa

"Apollo 11" rock shelter, Namibia

Swartkrans, South Africa

Shell beads, Blombos Cave, South Africa

Kakadu National Park, Australia